



and that interferes with everyday life. There is no approved medication for this type of addiction, but still most psychiatrists are treating video game addiction using psychiatric drugs.

Behavioural addiction is a kind of addiction that does not involve use of any drugs. This type of addiction happens because of the rewarding system of our brain. Our brain is functioning because of neurotransmitters like serotonin, GABA and dopamine. Certain activity or behaviour of a person can increase such neurotransmitter levels in the brain and give pleasure. This could vary from person to person, because everybody's brain chemistry is different. Some people might find video games addictive, while some might find them a waste of time.

Usually, any drug-related addiction is cured using de-addiction (substitute) drugs. In case of a drug addiction, the brain gets dependent on a particular drug, and to de-addict someone from that drug, a substitute drug is used with a tapering plan. As the substitute drug is tapered gradually on a daily



basis, the brain starts to reduce its dependency on the addicted drug.

Similarly, for any behavioural addiction like video gaming, de-addiction can be done using a substitute game. For example, when a user starts playing a game, he or she may find some difficulty in the beginning, but after winning the first level of the game, dopamine levels increase and he or she may want to play the next level. As the level goes up, difficulty level also goes up. This causes the brain to take stress from the game, and the user wants to play again and again to reach the top level (reward). This process makes anybody (from children to adults) get addicted to a video game.

Just like benzodiazepine is used as a substitute for alcohol addiction, a substitute video game can de-addict someone from such addictive games. Games like PUBG lead to addiction because of their algorithm and

interface. However, if a similar video game is developed by using reverse engineering and changing the gaming code so that the game is less difficult and therefore less rewarding, then that game can be de-addictive.

Just like most people do not like watching a movie twice, such substitute games would prevent people from playing addictive games again and again. However, to get rid of video game addiction, the best solution is to play them in limit for a certain period of time. Playing video games with breaks, instead of playing for hours, can also prevent addiction.

Psychological effect of video games

Video games can have a psychological effect on players, and all games are not suitable for every user of all age groups. Video games are rated by Entertainment Software Rating Board (ESRB) of USA according to age group. According to